

Question 44 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Explain e-learning as a training method and state its major advantages.

Answer

E-learning is training delivered through electronic media (LMS, online modules, virtual classrooms, mobile learning, webinars). It can be self-paced or live, standalone or blended with classroom and OJT.

- 1. Nature:** Uses digital content, interactivity, tracking and often multimedia to achieve learning objectives.
- 2. Advantage – flexibility:** Anytime, anywhere access; useful for dispersed or shift workers.
- 3. Advantage – scale and speed:** Same content to many employees quickly (e.g., compliance, product updates).
- 4. Advantage – cost over time:** After development, marginal cost per extra learner is low.
- 5. Advantage – standardisation:** Consistent quality versus variable classroom trainers.
- 6. Advantage – tracking:** LMS records completion, scores and time, aiding evaluation.
- 7. Advantage – personalisation:** Adaptive paths, micro-learning, replay of difficult parts.
- 8. Cautions:** Needs self-discipline, digital access, instructional design quality, and workplace support for transfer; not ideal alone for all complex interpersonal skills.

Conclusion. *E-learning is a powerful HRD method when content, technology and learner support are sound; its advantages are flexibility, scale, consistency and data.*